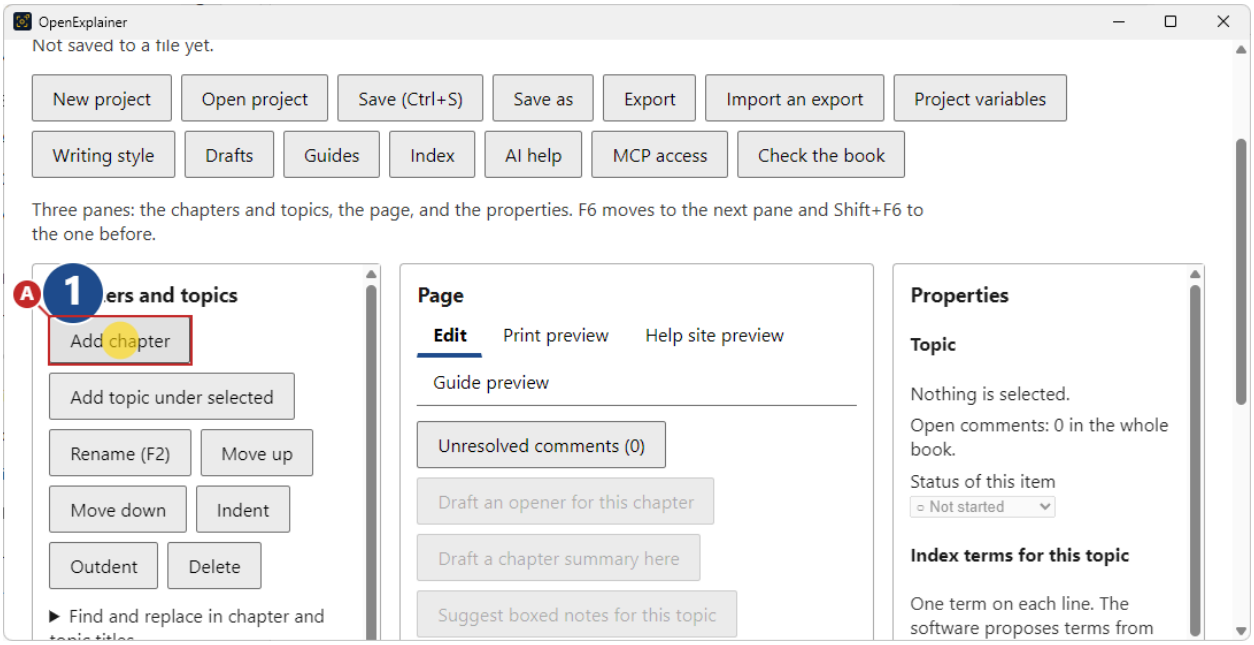
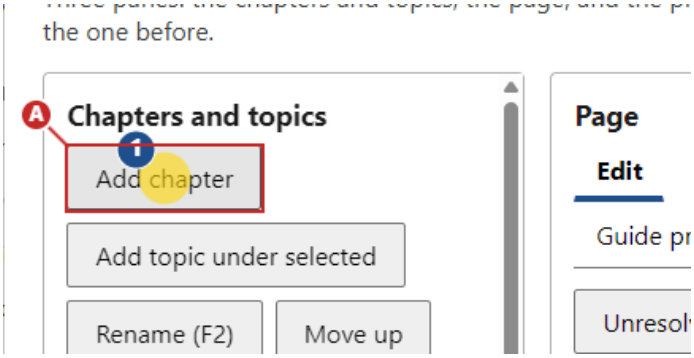
Quick Start: your first book

Making your first project

STEP 1



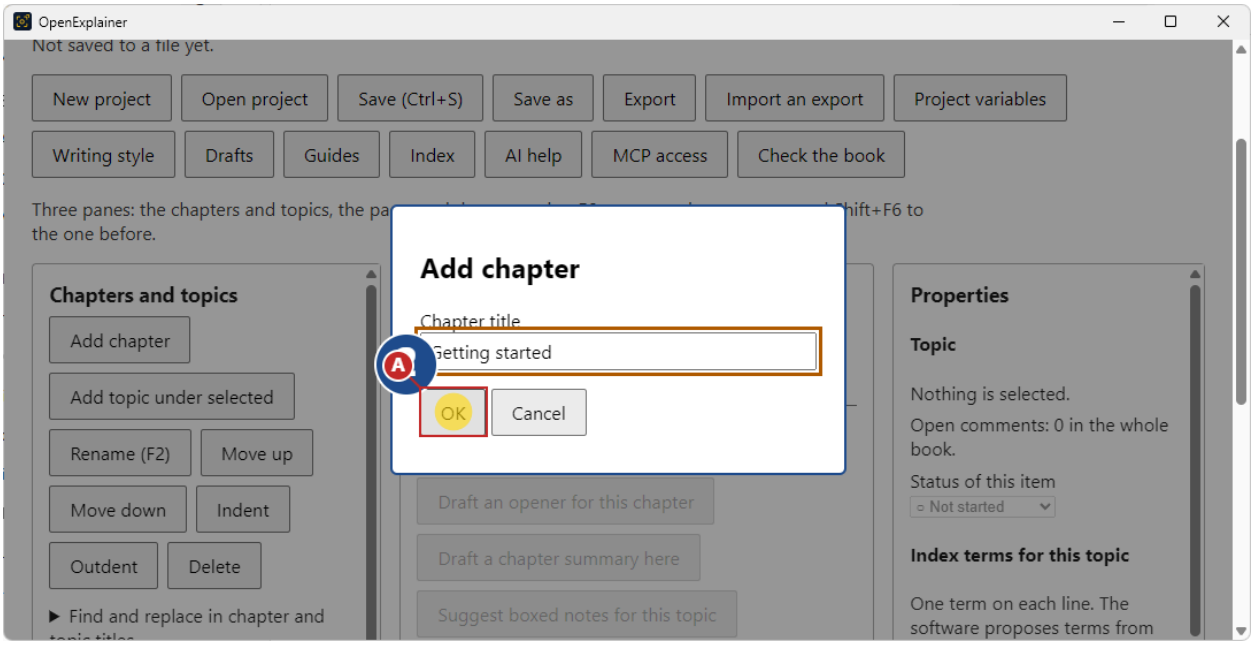
A. Add chapter: Starts a new chapter.



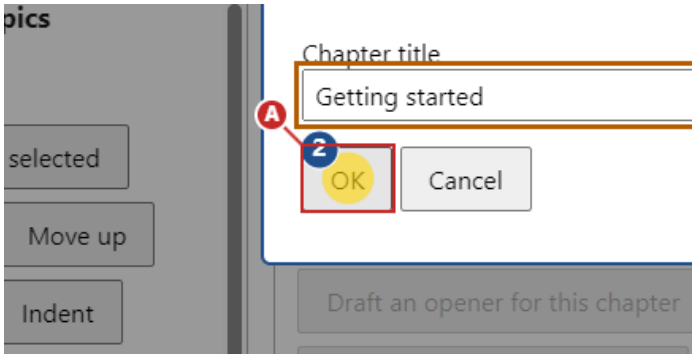
Click **Add chapter**.

Result: A small window asks for the chapter's title.

STEP 2



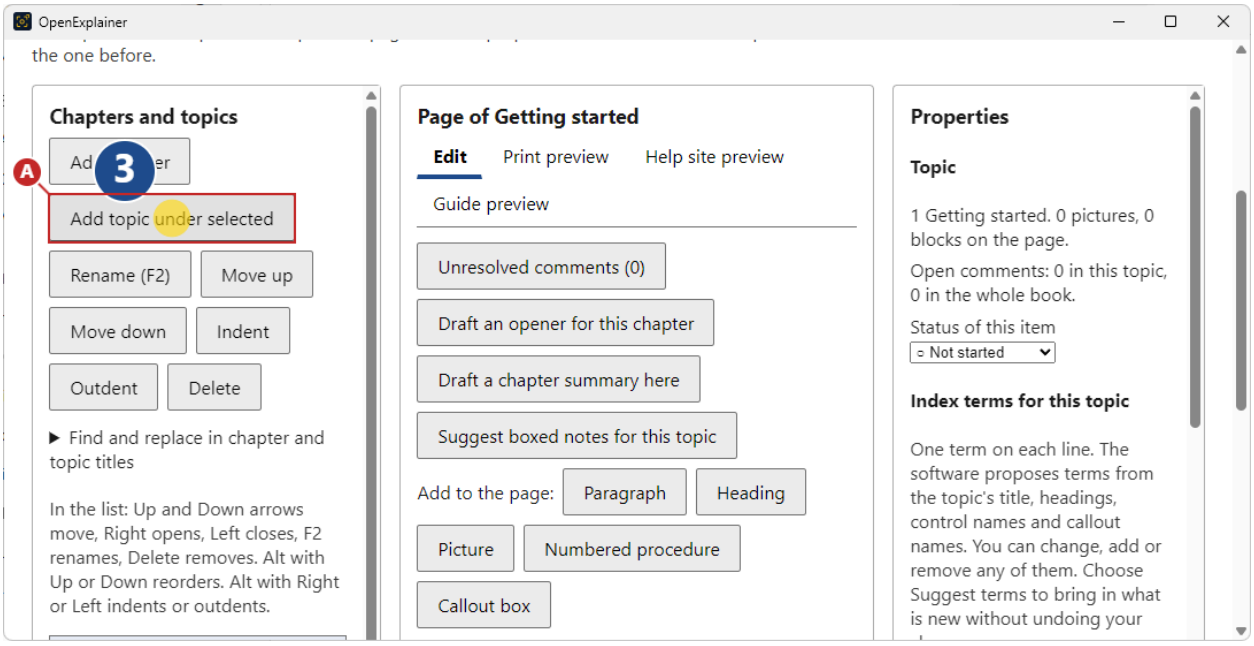
A. OK: Makes the chapter with the title you typed.



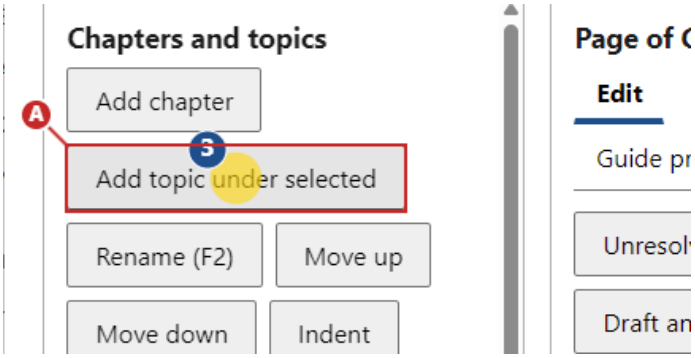
Type a title, such as Getting started, and click **OK**.

Result: The chapter appears in the list on the left.

STEP 3



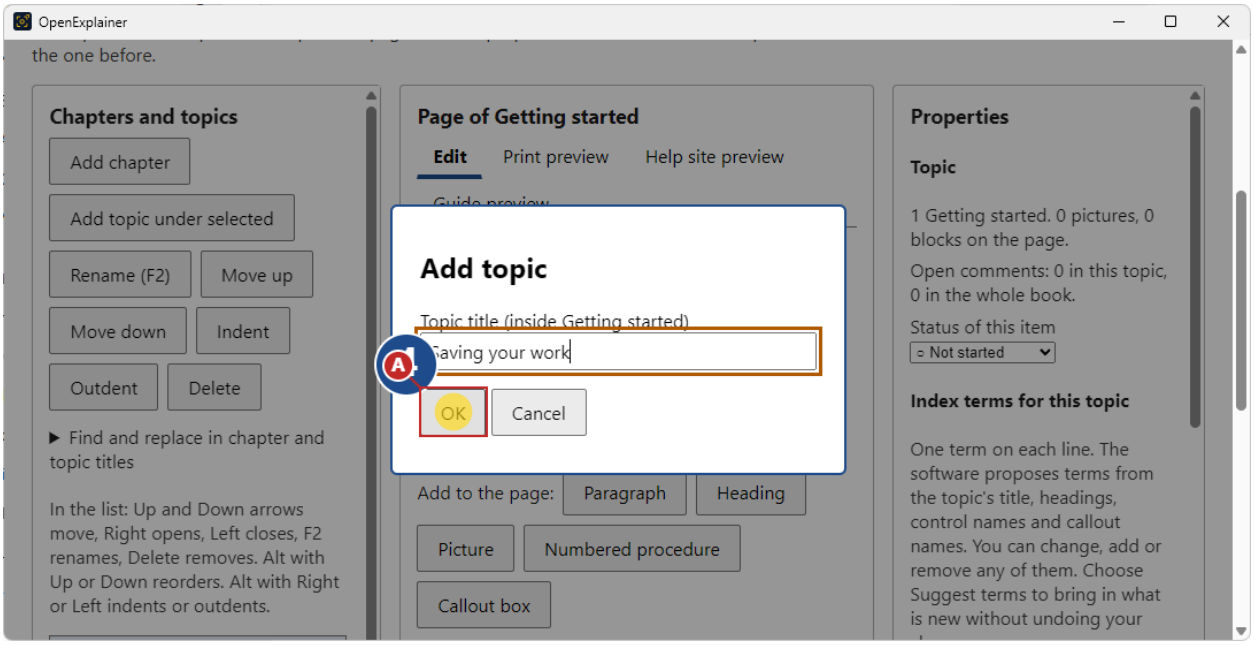
A. Add topic under selected: Starts a new topic inside the chapter that is selected.



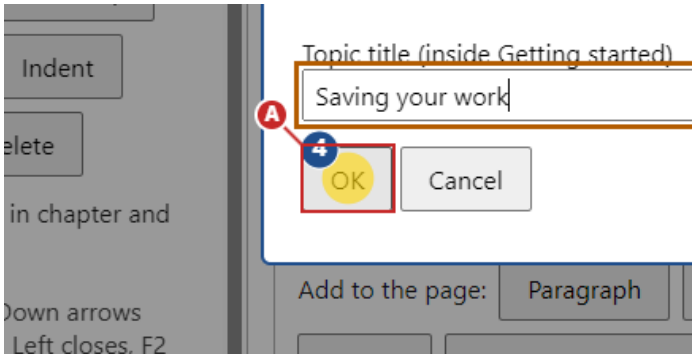
Click **Add topic under selected**.

Result: Another small window asks for the topic's title.

STEP 4



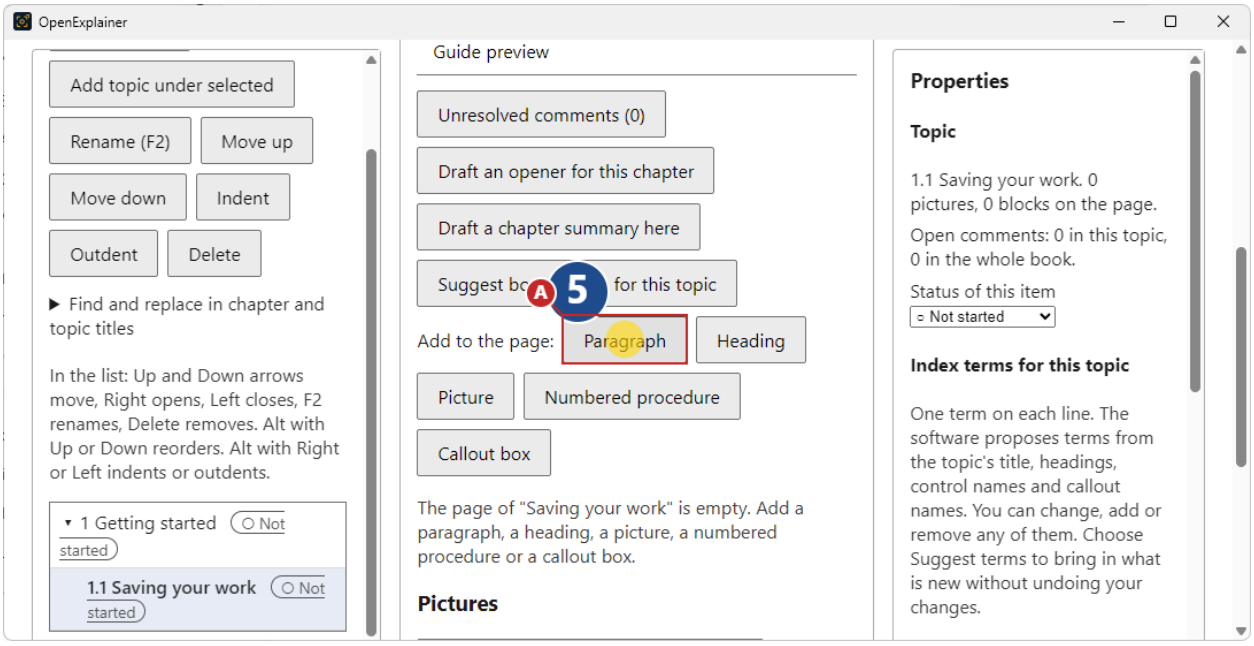
A. OK: Makes the topic with the title you typed.



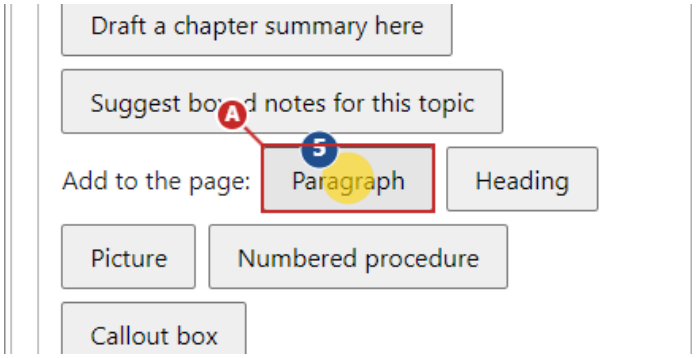
Type a title, such as Saving your work, and click **OK**.

Result: The topic appears under the chapter, and its page is empty.

STEP 5



A. Paragraph: Adds a box for a paragraph to the page.



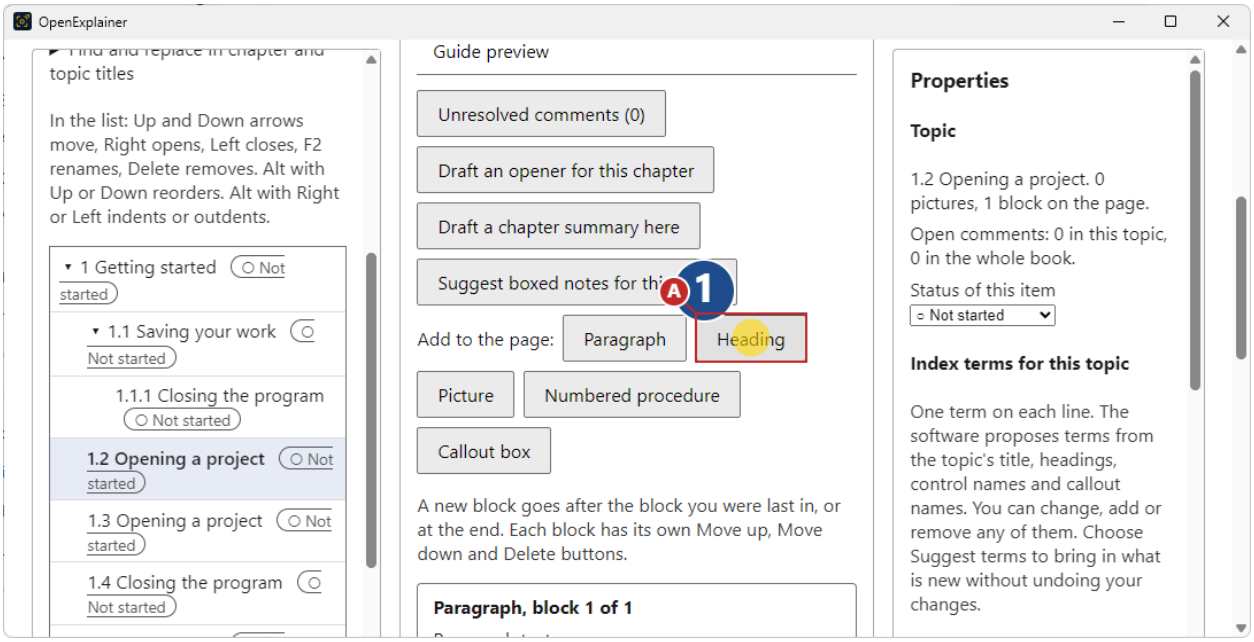
Click **Paragraph**.

Result: A box for a paragraph appears on the page, ready for you to type in.

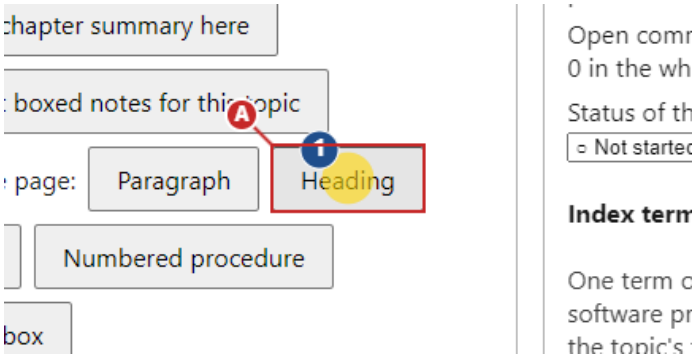
> **TIME SAVER**
>
> You can also use the keyboard for every one of these steps. Press Tab to move from button to button, and Enter to press the one you are on.

Writing a topic's page

STEP 1



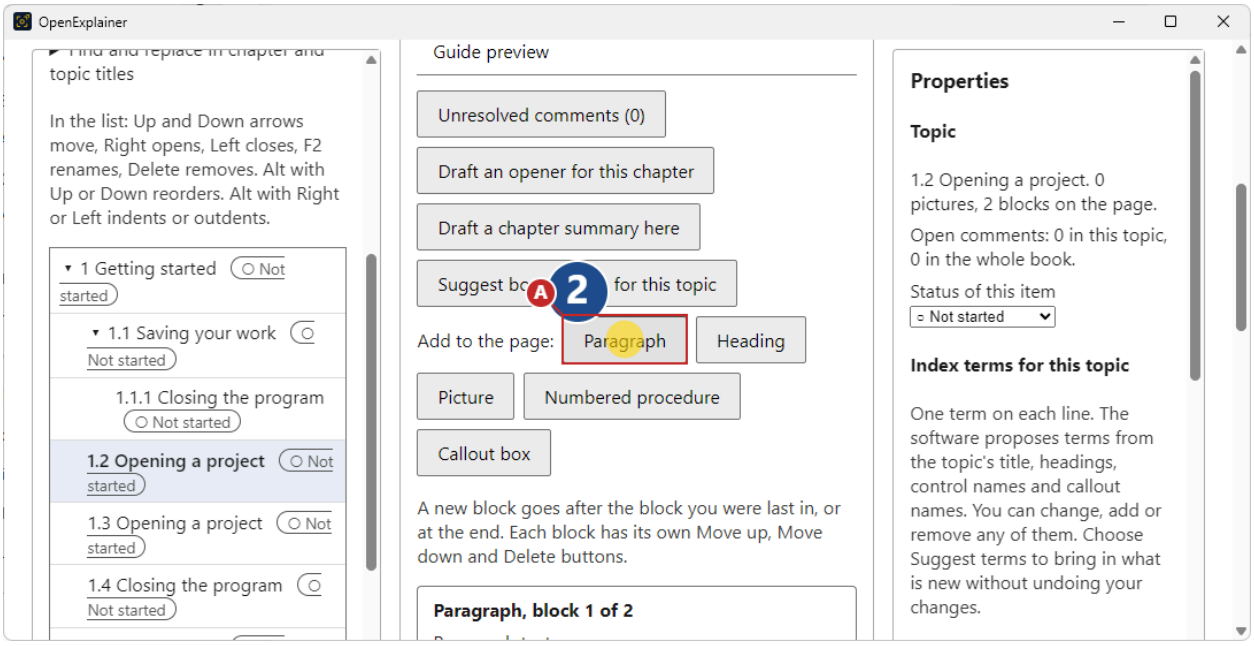
A. Heading: Adds a heading to the page.



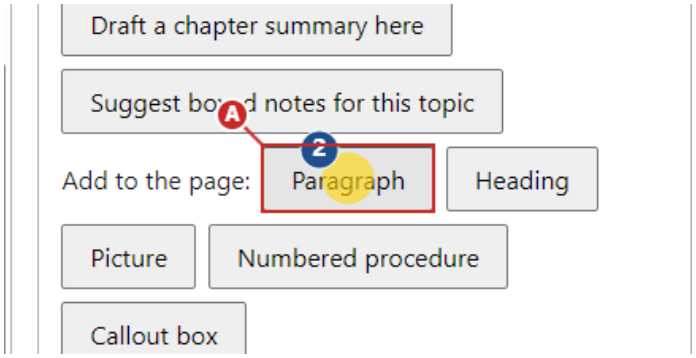
Click **Heading**.

Result: A heading box appears after the block you were last in, and the keyboard is already in it.

STEP 2



A. Paragraph: Adds a paragraph to the page.



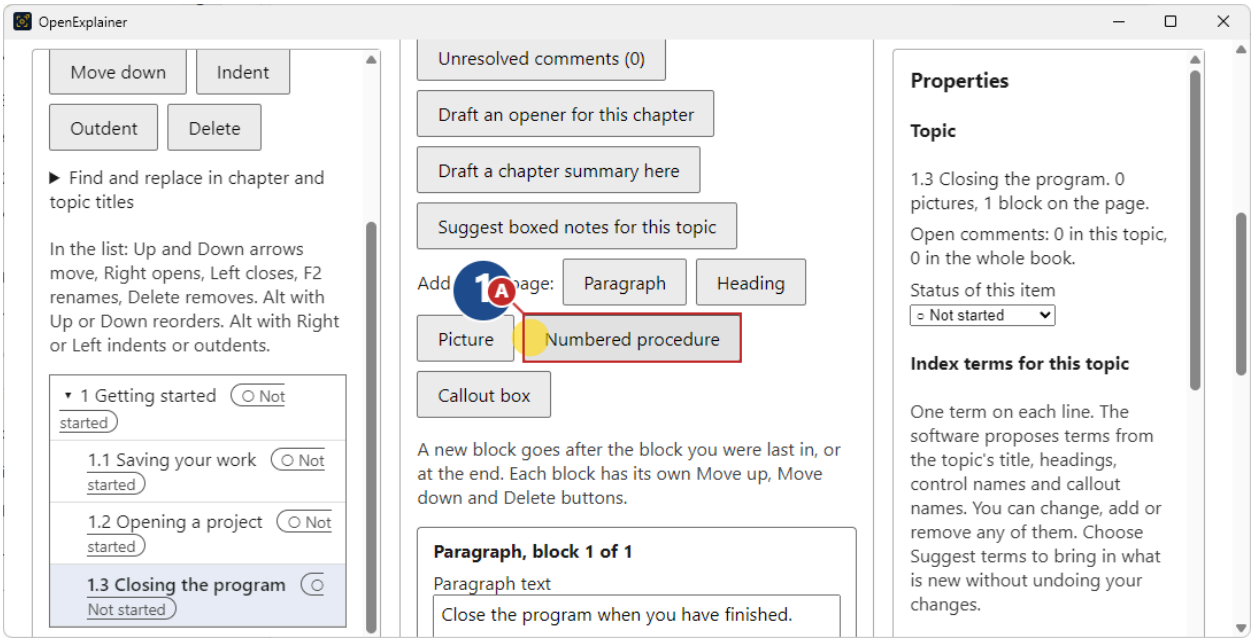
Type the heading, and then click **Paragraph**.

Result: A paragraph box appears. Type your text in it.

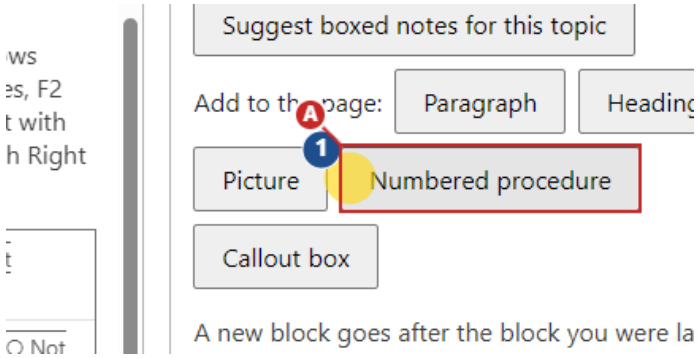
> **TIME SAVER**
>
> You do not need to save after every block. The title of the project says *unsaved changes* until you do, and Ctrl+S saves.

Numbered steps

STEP 1



A. Numbered procedure: Adds a list of numbered steps to the page.



Click **Numbered procedure**.

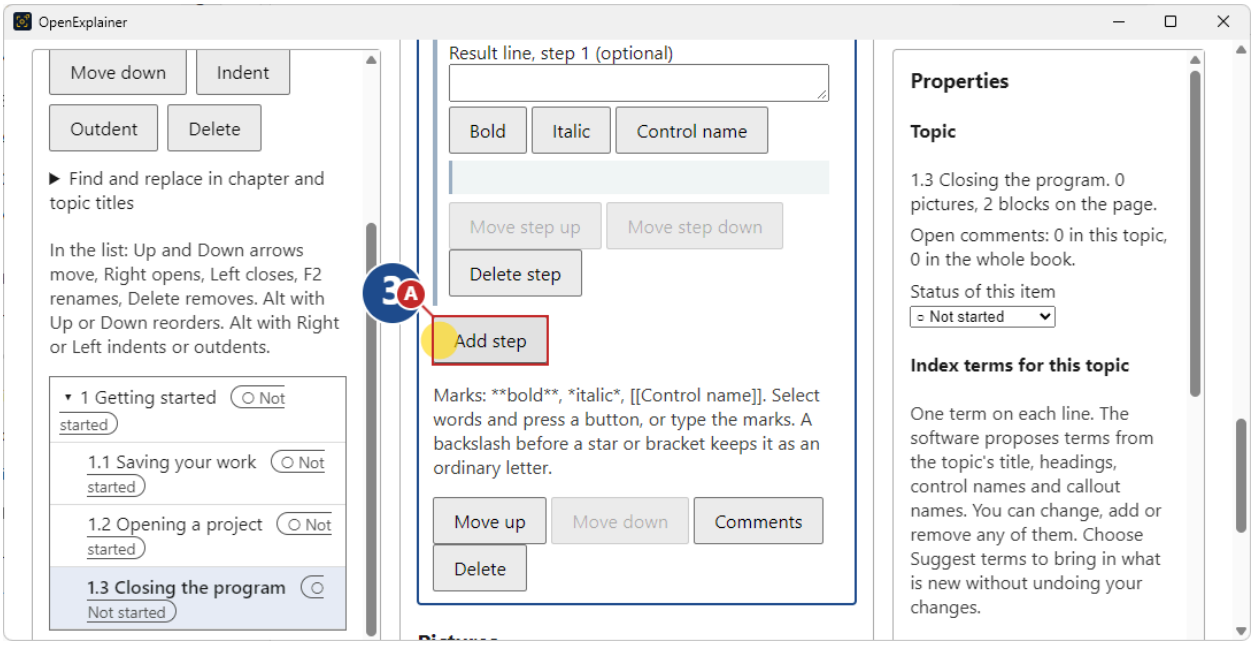
Result: A procedure with one empty step appears, and the keyboard is in its text box.

STEP 2

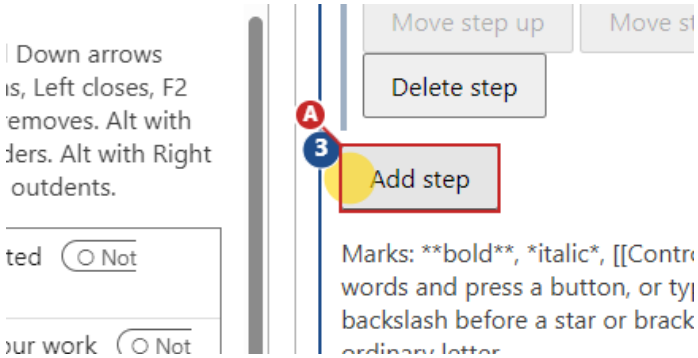
Type what the reader does, as a short sentence that starts with a verb.

Result: A line under the box shows how the step will look.

STEP 3



A. Add step: Adds another step to the end of the procedure.



Click **Add step** for the next step.

Result: Another step is added at the end, and the keyboard moves into it.

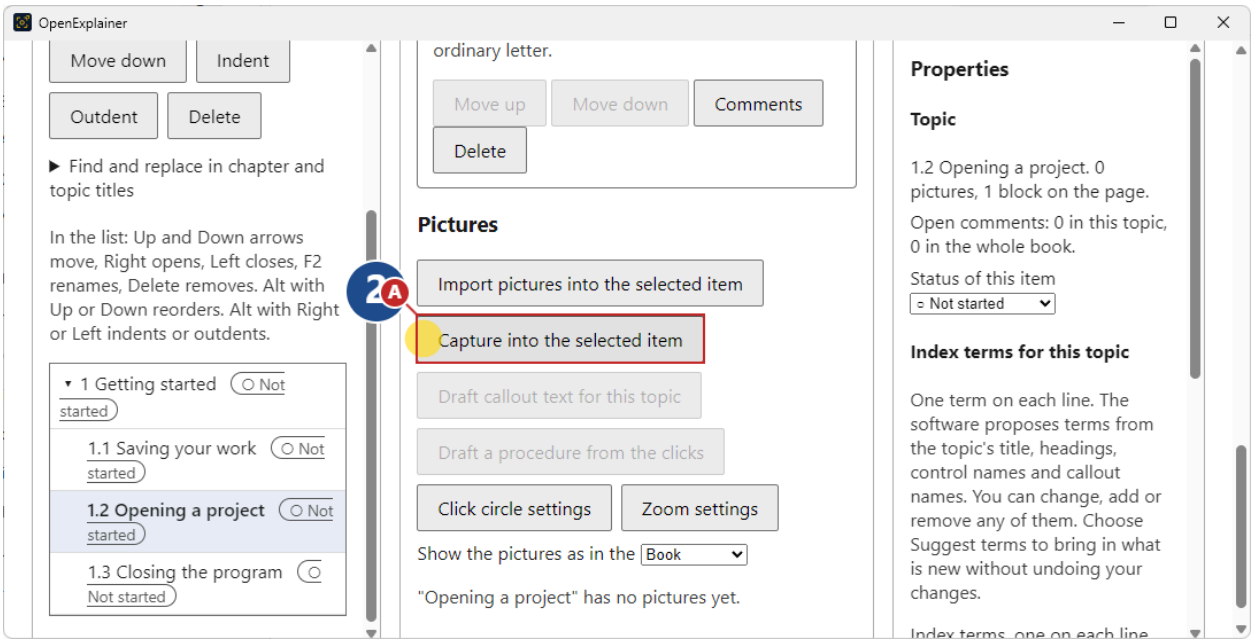
> **POWER TIP**
>
> If you take your pictures click by click (Chapter 4), OpenExplainer can write the first version of the steps for you from what you clicked, with no AI. Press **Draft a procedure from the clicks** in the Pictures area.

Capturing a window

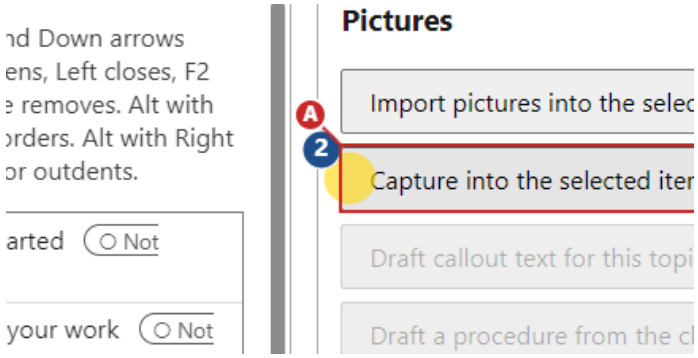
STEP 1

In the list on the left, select the topic that the picture belongs to.

STEP 2



A. Capture into the selected item: Opens the Capture window, where you choose what to capture.



Click **Capture into the selected item**.

Result: A window called Capture asks what you want to capture.

STEP 3

Choose **A window**.

STEP 4

Click the program's window in the list called Open windows.

Result: Each entry gives the window's title, the program's name and its size. A window that belongs to another window, such as the Save or Open window of the program, is in the list too.

STEP 5

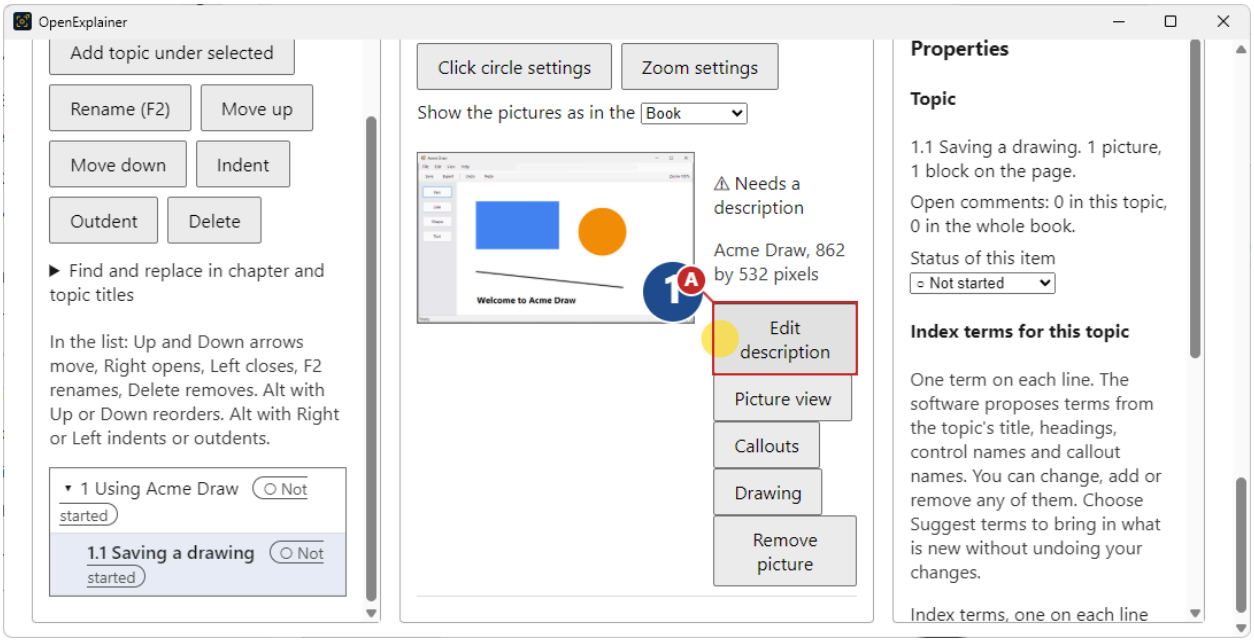
Click **Capture**.

Result: OpenExplainer hides for a moment, takes the picture and comes back. The picture is in the topic's list of pictures.

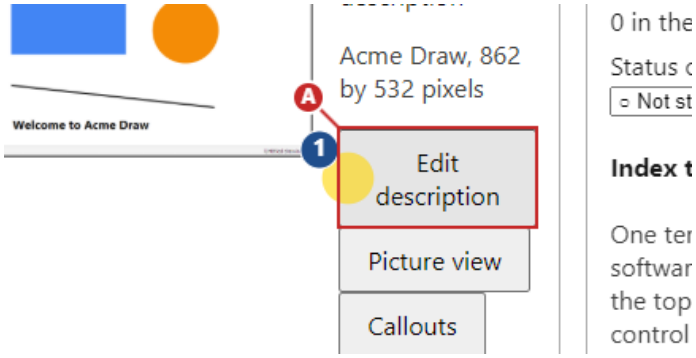
> **⚠ CAUTION**
> The picture shows exactly what is in the window at that moment. Look at each picture before you share the book, in case something private was open.

Describing a picture for readers who cannot see it

STEP 1



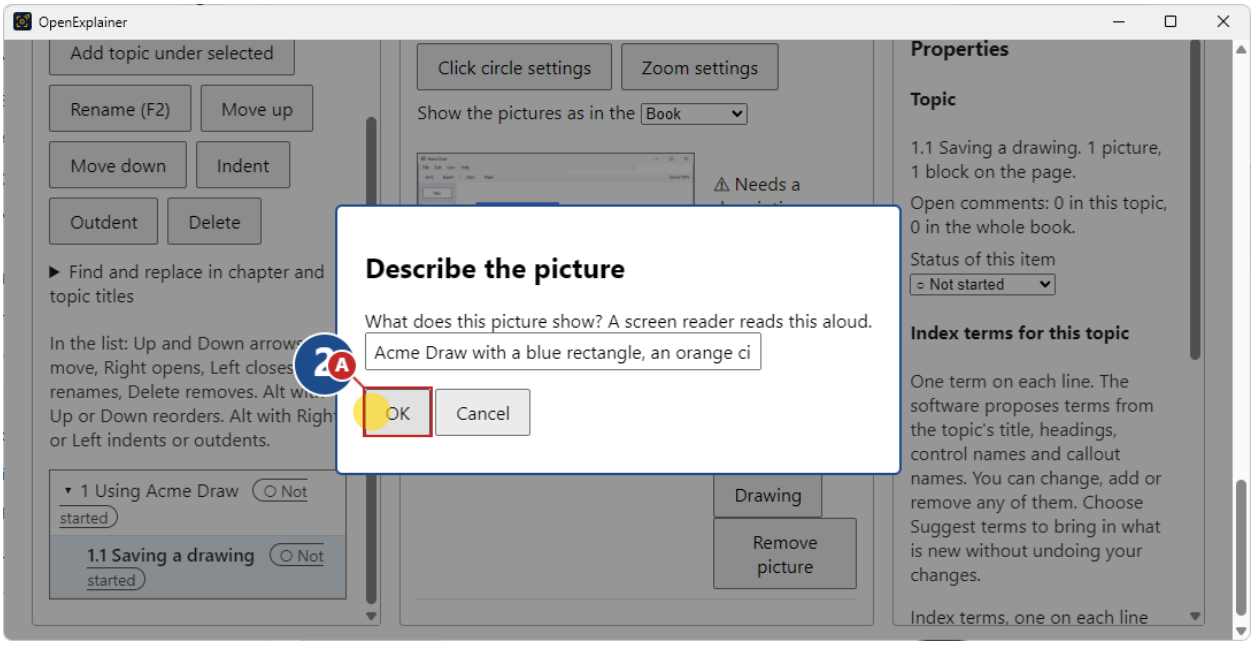
A. Edit description: Opens a window where you say what the picture shows.



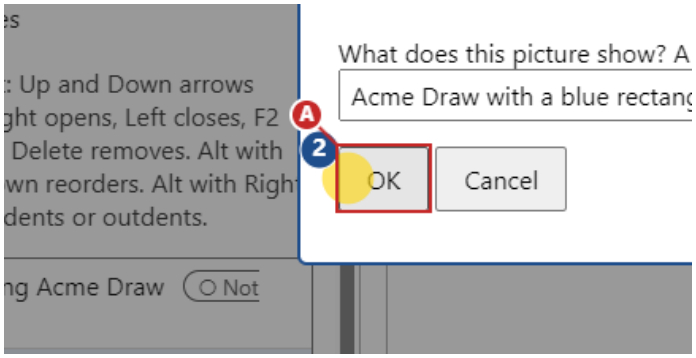
Find the picture in the list called Pictures, under the page. A picture with no description says *Needs a description*. Click **Edit description**.

Result: A window called Describe the picture opens.

STEP 2



A. OK: Keeps the description.



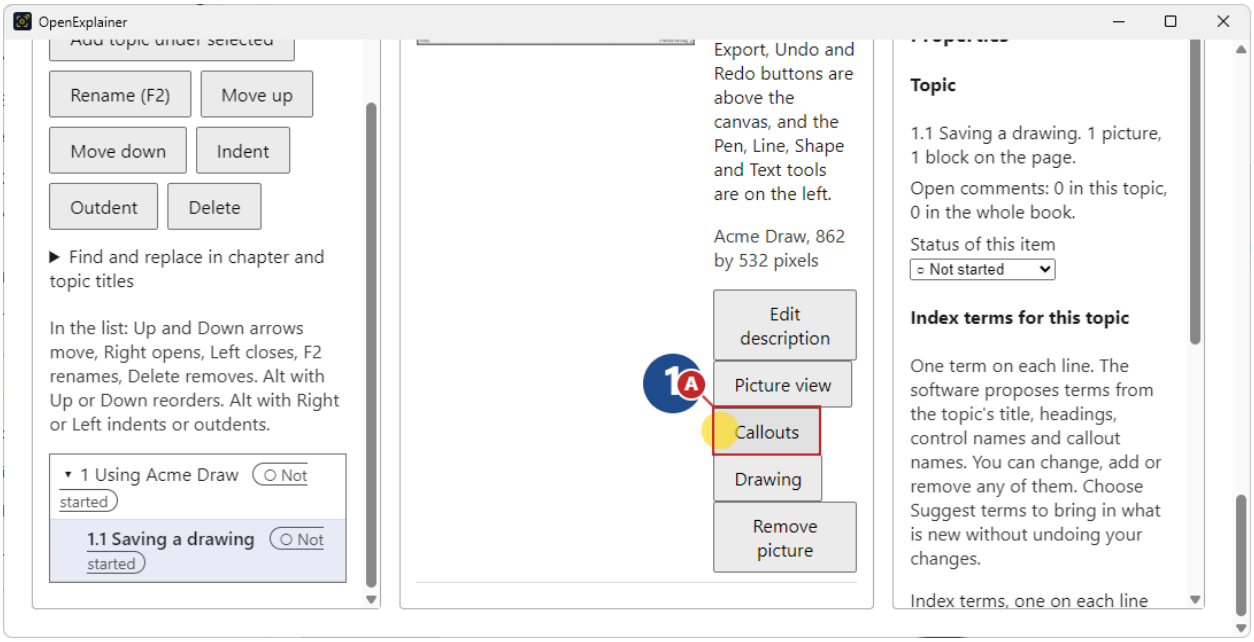
Type what the picture shows, and click **OK**.

Result: The list now shows your words after the word *Description*, in place of the warning.

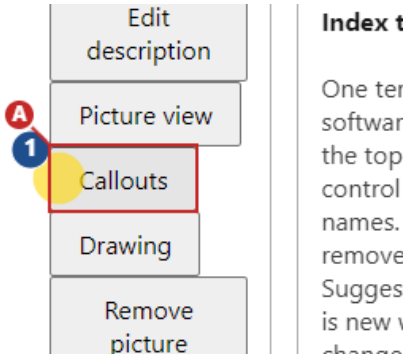
> **⚠ CAUTION**
>
> A picture with no description is the most common accessibility problem in a book. The book check (Chapter 6) lists every one of them.

Callouts

STEP 1



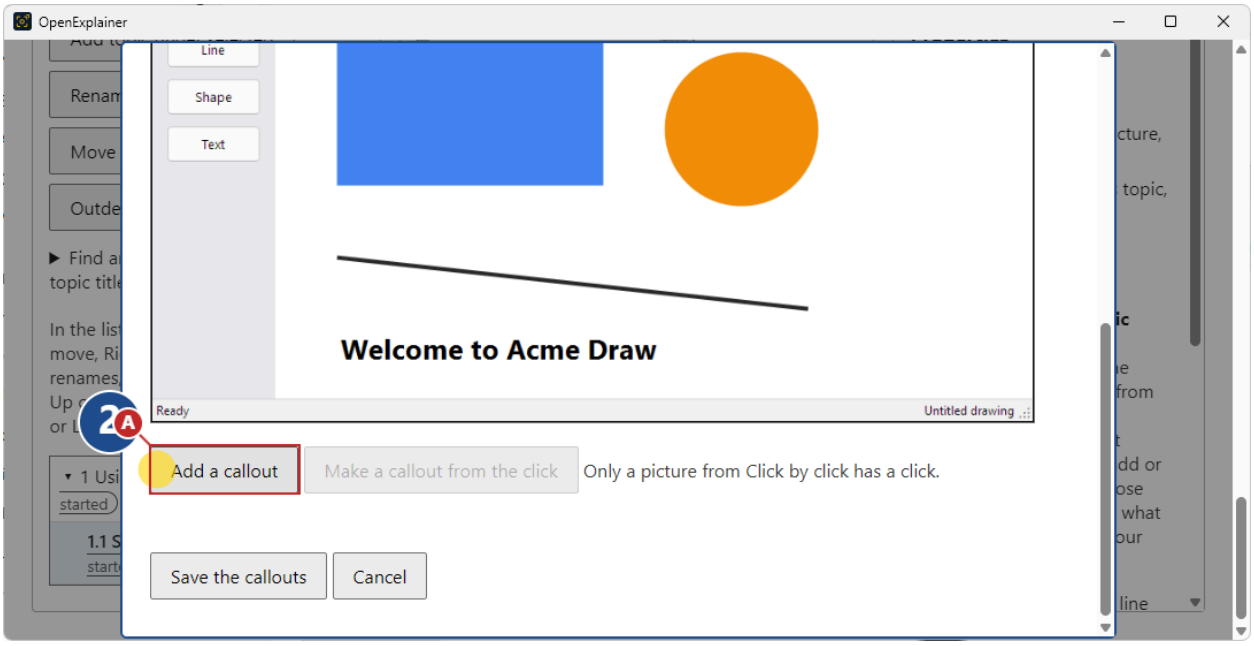
A. Callouts: Opens the window where the picture's callouts are made and changed.



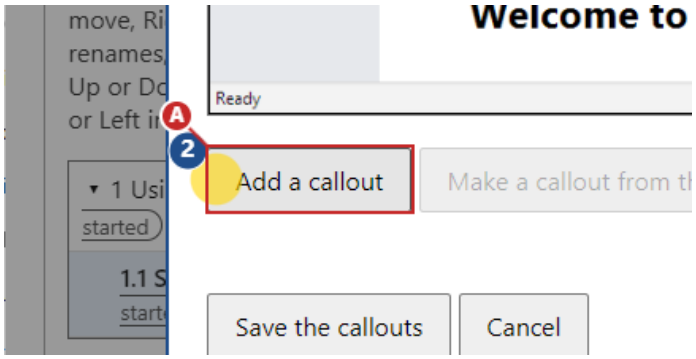
Under the picture in the list, click **Callouts**.

Result: A window called Callouts opens, with a sample of the picture.

STEP 2



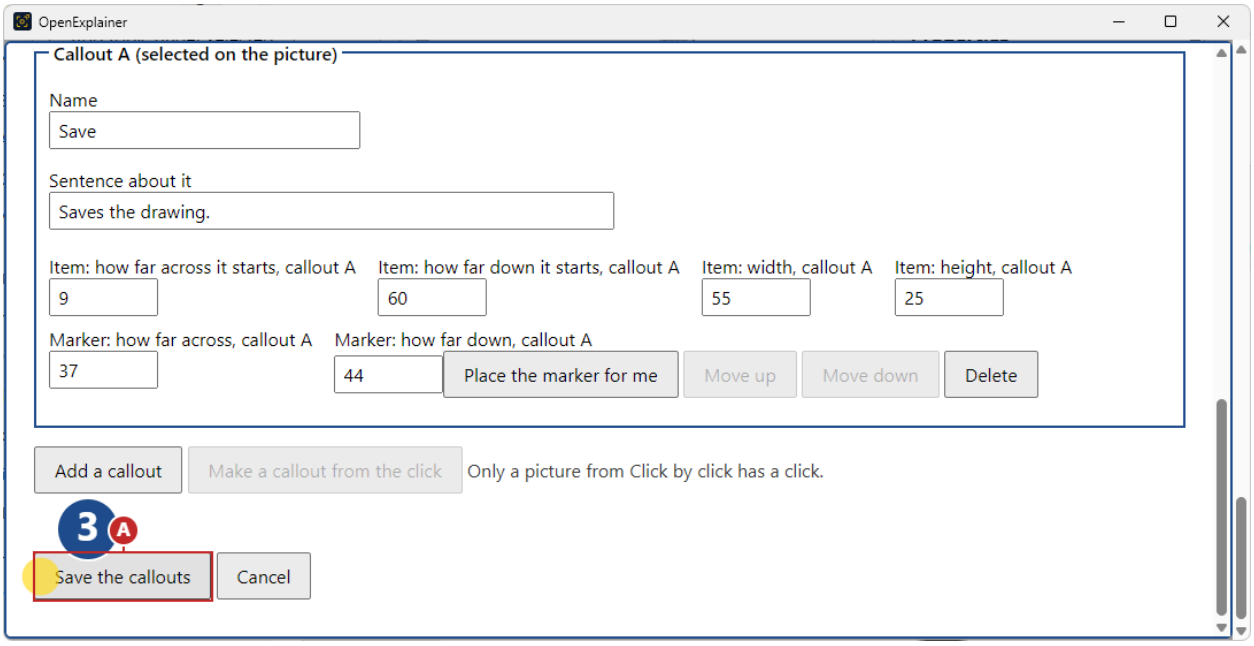
A. Add a callout: Adds a new callout to the picture.



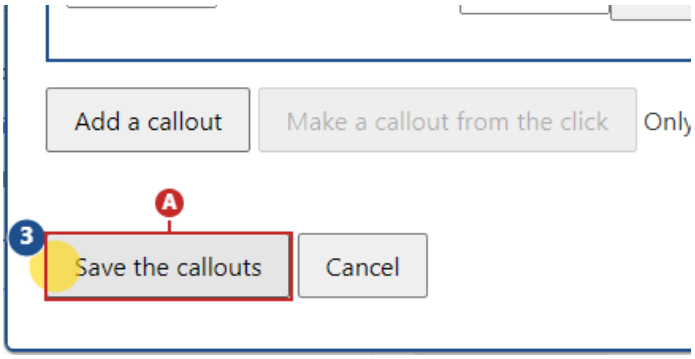
Click **Add a callout**.

Result: A group of boxes for callout A appears, and an outline appears on the sample.

STEP 3



A. Save the callouts: Keeps the callouts and closes the window.



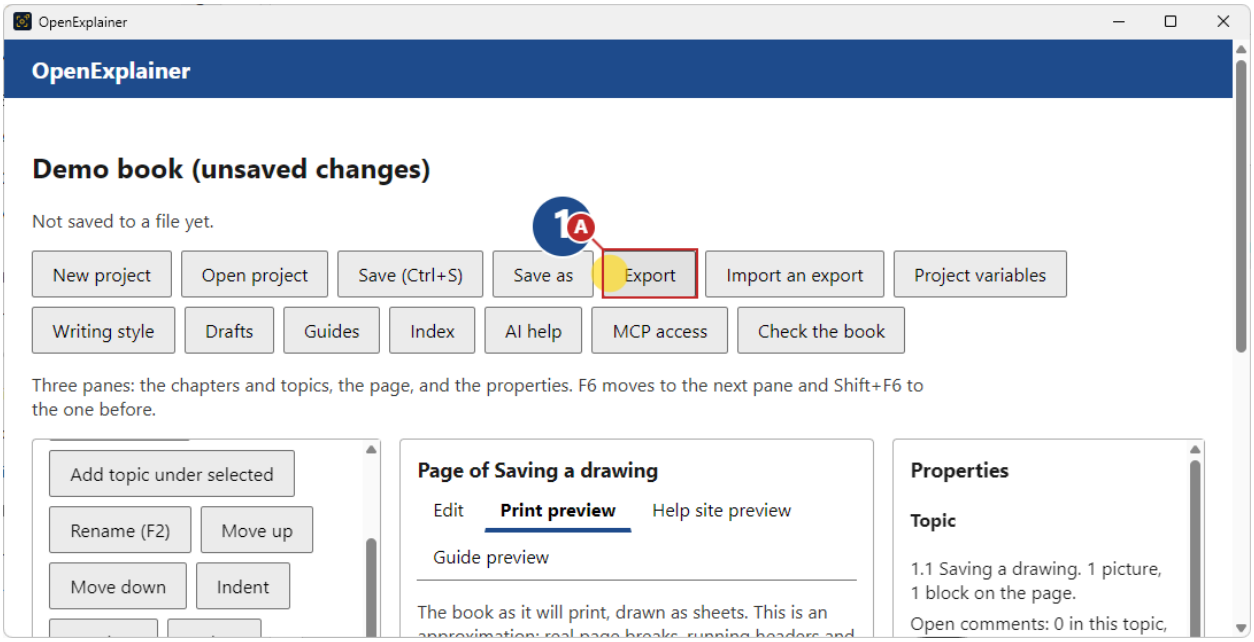
Type the name of the part and a sentence about it. Place the outline on the part (see below), and click **Save the callouts**.

Result: The callouts appear on the picture, and the entries appear under it.

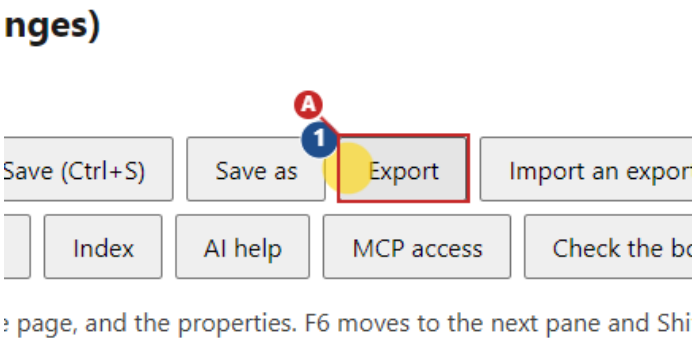
> ✳ **BRIGHT IDEA**
>
> A callout with no name or no sentence is shown in words as *needs a name* or *needs a description*, never hidden. The book check lists them too. If the built-in model is on, **Draft callout text** can suggest the sentences (Chapter 8), and you review each one.

A PDF for paper

STEP 1



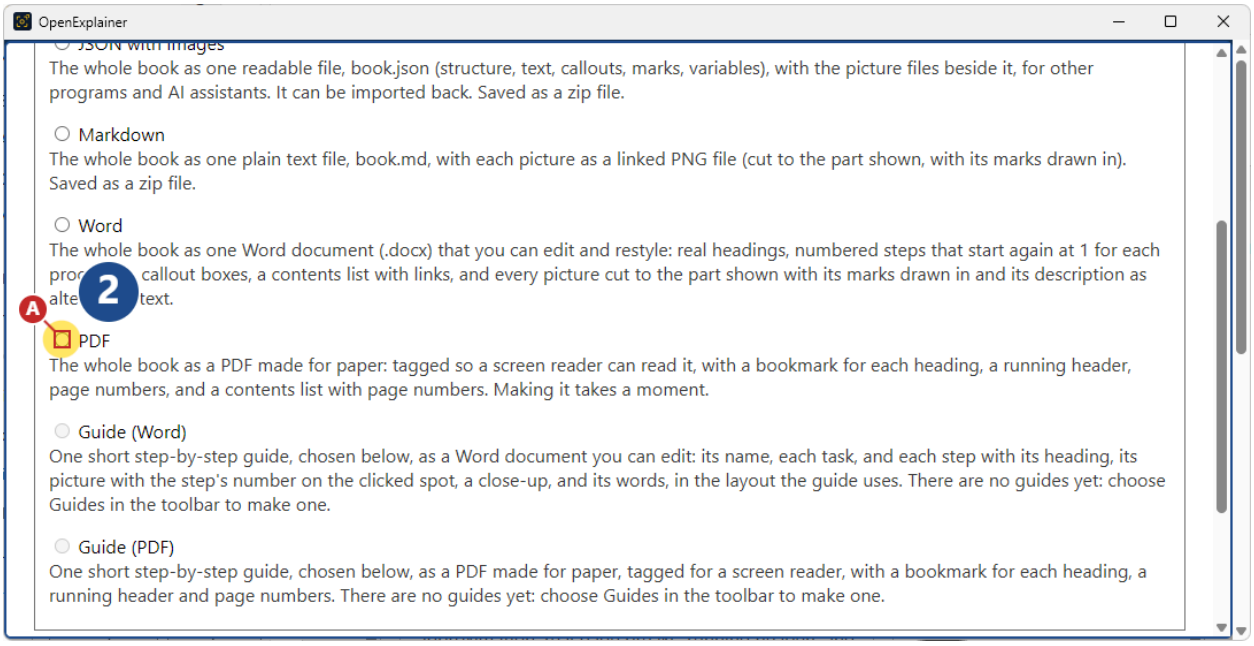
A. Export: Opens the window where you choose what to make.



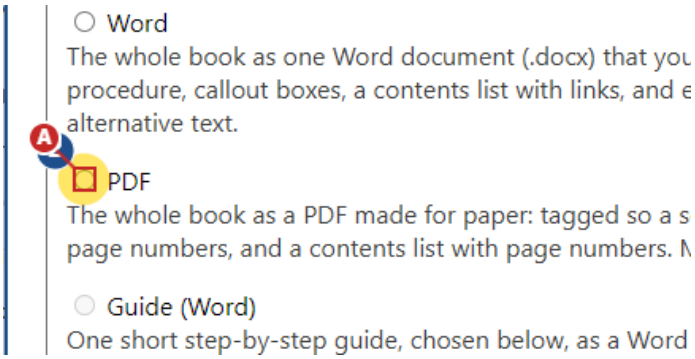
Click **Export**.

Result: A window called Export lists what can be made, with a sentence about each.

STEP 2



A. PDF: Makes the whole book as a PDF for paper, with a contents list and page numbers.



Choose **PDF**.

Result: The sentence under it says that the PDF is tagged for a screen reader and has a bookmark for each heading.

STEP 3

Click Export at the bottom of the window, and choose where to save the file in Windows' Save window.

Result: The program makes the PDF, which takes a moment, and then says where the file was saved.

> **⚠ CAUTION**
>
> The book's own fonts are Georgia for the text and Segoe UI for the headings, as installed on your PC, and the PDF embeds the ones it used. A PC without them falls back to Times New Roman and Arial.